

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, April 12, 2017, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:32 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

Ward I Councilor Carolyn Towle
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope
At-Large Councilor Keith Raymond
Assistant Mayor Victor Bergeron
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Allen Damren
At-Large Councilor Bruce Temple
Ward III Councilor Nicholas Koloski
At-Large Councilor John Simonds

Also present were:

Ryan McNutt, City Manager
Jane Taylor, City Solicitor

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Lovett said Ratification of Union Contracts would be moved to the April 26th meeting.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Mr. Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Towle to accept the minutes of the March 8, 2017, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 6-0 with 2 abstain (Mr. Simonds and Mayor Lovett as they were not at the meeting).

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Simonds to accept the minutes of the March 22, 2017, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

MAYOR'S NOTES

Tracy Pope, Ward 2, spoke on behalf of the New England Organ Bank saying that April is Donate Life Month. She talked about the kidney she received in 2012 from her husband which saved her life. She introduced other organ donors or recipients, including Councilor Carolyn Towle, heart recipient, and her husband Councilor Scott Pope, living donor.

Mayor Lovett presented Mrs. Pope with a proclamation, naming April 2017 as Donate Life Month.

Mayor Lovett said April is sexual abuse awareness month and Turning Points Network will be having a fundraising walk, Steppin' Up to End Violence. The Council will have a team in that fundraiser.

Mayor Lovett said April is community-wide cleanup month. April 22nd will be free tire disposal day. Public Works will pick up leaves the first week in May. She encouraged residents to look for hotspots in their neighborhoods and for Ward Councilors to see what they can do in their Wards to clean up the hotspots. She and her family has started cleaning up on the Bobby Woodman Trail.

Mr. McNutt said the City has purchased gloves, road vests and trash bags for volunteers doing the cleanup. He said groups should contact the City Manager's office.

Mayor Lovett said that Senate Bill 57, funding eligible drinking water and wastewater projects under the state aid grant program, has passed the Senate. It will be heard by House Finance Committee Division 1. If passed, Claremont will get about \$27,000 a year until \$255,000 has been received.

Mayor Lovett said Senate Bill 247, preventing childhood lead poisoning from paint and water and making an appropriation to a special fund, has passed the Senate. If it passes as is, it will require lead testing of all 1 and 2 year olds. It also includes money to help residents remove lead from their homes.

Mr. McNutt said that despite stories to the contrary, he has heard that HUD (Housing and Urban Development) will maintain funding for lead based paint abatement grants.

Mayor Lovett said tomorrow U.S. Senator Shaheen will be in Claremont for a meeting with a local business to talk about HUBZone districts.

Mayor Lovett said there was a public forum on the Amtrak stop last night.

Mayor Lovett said from October to February this year, ridership has gone up 12.5% over the same time last year. Over the last two years, the ridership has gone up a total of almost 30%.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Mr. McNutt said in February, Brenda Tripodes, Childrens' Librarian retired after 22 years of service. Christopher Calkins of the Fire Department retired after 20 years of service. Claremont's Fire Station will be 100 years old this year. He congratulated the Fire Chief and staff for all the work done to maintain the building. Valerie Azotea, Central Collections, retired after 18 years of service.

Mr. McNutt said Saturday, April 29th, 10 a.m. to 2 p.m., will be Drug Take Back Day. Drop off is in the CVS parking lot. Also, the Sullivan County Sheriff's office will participate in Newport. The Claremont Police Department also has a drop box.

Mr. McNutt said April 19, 6:30 p.m., Kinan Azmeh's CityBand will perform at the West Claremont Center for Music & the Arts to kick off its 10th season at the Union Episcopal Church.

Mr. McNutt talked about code enforcement emphasizing landlord issues and that he is actively looking to have night time inspectors. Street sweeping began April 10th and line painting will begin May 7th. Yard waste pick up will begin May 1st.

Mr. Damren asked about going further down Myrtle Street for the sidewalk project. Public Works Director Scott Sweet said that Belding and Myrtle Streets sidewalks are in the Safe Routes to Schools Project.

Mr. Koloski talked about questions/complaints from Ward 3 residents regarding a local property and whether or not they can expect to get responses. Mr. McNutt said he could give responses to those folks, but it is not just one simple issue. Some are City issues and some are neighbor to neighbor disputes. He would like to take the time to review those complaints and respond to the ones that may involve the City taking some action. City staff have been investigating these complaints. If there are further questions, they can call the City Manager's office.

Mr. Pope asked about clean-up day. Mr. McNutt said there is no specific day. Mr. Pope said there are some groups that are interested in participating: Claremont Citizens Group, Heart of Claremont, Healthy, Vital Claremont Group, Chamber; and he will give their contact information to Mr. McNutt.

Mr. Koloski said two City department Facebook pages have gone live: CSB Community Center/Parks and Recreation and Police.

Fire Chief Rick Bergeron talked about the annual calendar published by the Fire Marshal's office. Two third graders from Disnard Elementary School had their fire safety posters selected to be included in the 2018 calendar.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Tax Increment Finance District Advisory Board – Downtown

A motion was made by Mr. Bergeron and seconded by Mr. Damren to appoint Martha Maki to seat #3, Owner or occupant of real property located within or adjacent to the TIF District, of the Tax Increment Finance District Advisory Board – Downtown.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Simonds to appoint Derek Ferland to seat #5, Member-At-Large, of the Tax Increment Finance District Advisory Board – Downtown.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Jim Feleen, Ward 2, talked about the Rail Trail that is owned by the City and that it is his understanding that the City is in the process of conveying an easement to the Rail Trail to an abutting property owner. He said if that is true, he thinks it is premature and inappropriate. There has been a mini Master Plan process going on, i.e. landscaping, shelters, etc. and he thinks if you grant this to one landowner, it will have to be opened up to others.

Ms. Taylor said she is not aware of any easement activity or anyone asking for an easement. If anyone knows of an encroachment, they should bring it to the Conservation Commission's attention.

Nancy Merrill, Planning and Development Director, said that TAP (Transportation Alternatives Program) Grant surveying is going on from Pleasant Street to Chestnut Street. The Conservation Commission voted to pay for a survey on the Trail from the bridge to VIP Tires and Service. Ms. Taylor said if there is any encroachment discovered as a result of the survey, the City will have some better grounds to deal with it.

Steve Raymond, Ward 1, asked for clarification on a tree issue. He sent pictures to the City Manager and Public Works regarding unsafe trees. He said he hasn't heard from anyone. He said he's concerned about some trees on Chestnut Street and the safety of the people of Claremont.

Mr. Koloski asked that the Council be furnished with copies of the 18-19 complaints he referenced. He hopes they can be more directly addressed. He acknowledged he has property abutting the property that is being referred to.

Bernie Folta, Ward 3, said that a story in the Washington Post said the budget that President Trump released to Congress may include eliminating some funding for Amtrak.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 553 Revision to Division of Highway Authority – Second Reading – Public Hearing

The purpose of this proposed change is to clarify the authority of the Public Works Department to maintain and, if necessary, remove vegetation and trees along City streets and sidewalks. The Public Works Department has historically undertaken these tasks, but the authority to do so is not expressly delegated to the Department.

Enactment of this ordinance will clarify the authority of the Public Works Department to maintain and, if necessary, remove vegetation and trees along City streets and sidewalks.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Koloski to adopt Ordinance 553 Revision to Division of Highway Authority on Second Reading.

Mr. Damren read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

Mr. Sweet said Public Works has been doing this all along. Before they do work on trees, they talk to the abutting landowner.

Mr. Koloski asked who bears the costs. Ms. Taylor said if it is on private property, is a hazard and the City determines it needs to come down, the City goes through the notification process and then the cost is borne by the City.

Mr. McNutt said if anyone is concerned about trees, they can come to the City Manager's Office and the information will be forwarded to Public Works.

Mr. Sweet said regarding the trees on Chestnut Street, two of the trees Steve Raymond referred to are on state property and the state is responsible for taking care of them. The other is not a direct hazard. On Paddy Hollow Road, some limbs were cut down. Mr. Sweet apologized that he did not follow-up with Mr. Raymond.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing.

Steve Raymond, Ward 1, asked for clarification that if Chestnut Street is a state road, why does the City do water line repairs.

Mr. Raymond asked if Mayor Lovett would read into the record, the letter he sent 2 weeks ago.

Mr. Sweet said regarding the state's right-of-way, the state takes care of everything other than utilities (City does that).

Mr. Temple said when a tree is in the state right-of-way, the state decides how to handle it.

Mr. Raymond said his biggest concern is that the decision shouldn't be all up to Public Works. If a tree is on private property, there should be some guidance in place where the private property owner should take care of.

Mayor Lovett read into the record the February 22, 2017, letter from Steve Raymond saying that homeowners should be responsible for trees that are on their properties.

Bernie Folta, Ward 3, said he is an affected property owner. He has a privet hedge that overhangs the sidewalk. He was not notified before Public Works trimmed it. If he had been notified, he would have said to leave the wood. He suggested that if it was in the ordinance and the policy that the abutter shall be notified of a planned activity, that would institutionalize that.

Mayor Lovett closed the public hearing.

Ms. Taylor said the purpose of the ordinance is authorization that Public Works handle this. As far as the notice in the policy, it comes directly from the statute. Notice only applies to those hazardous trees. It does not apply to limbing or brush.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Cemetery Books

Mr. Sweet showed pictures of deteriorated cemetery books and that a \$9,200 Moose Grant was used to repair some of the books. All the cemetery books are now stabilized. Joseph Fahey, for his Eagle Scout Project, created a grid of Broad Street Cemetery (the original book was destroyed in a fire) and now there is a record. Norma Limoges worked on the grants. They are now doing two deed books. The data from these books has been digitized.

NEW BUSINESS

License Agreement for Agricultural Use – Map 152-7

Ms. Merrill said that Gary LeClair farms a piece of City-owned property next to Tambrands. He pays the taxes on that property. He requested this be a 5-year lease. There is notice in the agreement that the agreement can end, if the City develops or sells the property.

Ms. Taylor clarified that this is a license.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Mr. Damren to authorize the City Manager or his designees to negotiate and enter into a License Agreement with Gary LeClair to use a portion of Parcel 152-7 for agricultural use for five (5) years, subject to payment of property taxes levied on Licensee's use of the property and subject to a provision that the license may be terminated, without penalty, if the City sells or otherwise develops the property.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2017-39 Accept and Expend EMPG for EOC Dispatch Equipment – Public Hearing

The City of Claremont has been awarded a grant from the New Hampshire Department of Safety, Division of Homeland Security and Emergency Management (the "State") for the purchase of Emergency Operations Center (EOC) Dispatch Equipment in the amount of \$7,562.00 toward the total project cost of \$15,124.00. The City would like to accept the Grant Agreement, as presented, and expend the grant funds for their intended purpose. The City is required to provide \$7,562.00 in matching funds as a condition of accepting the grant funds. This is to raise, appropriate and expend up to \$15,124.00, with up to \$7,562.00 to be received from State grant

funds (to have no impact on the tax rate), and up to \$7,562.00 to come from money already appropriated in the 2017 budget for the purpose of purchasing EOC Dispatch Equipment.

Chief Bergeron said this is a grant to improve dispatch capabilities at the EOC. There is a 50% match. Three-quarters of the City's portion of the 50% is a soft match. Also, included in this is air conditioning for the network room.

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Ms. Towle to adopt Resolution 2017-39 Accept and Expend EMPG for EOC Dispatch Equipment.

Mr. Pope read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 8-0.

Ordinance 554 Zoning – Accessory Dwelling Units – First Reading

The purpose of this proposed ordinance is to ensure that the Claremont City Code will comply with changes to state law regarding accessory dwelling units that go into effect June 1, 2017. The Code's current provisions regarding accessory dwelling units do not comply with the new law and will not be enforceable after June 1. Additionally, if the City does not adopt provisions that comply with state law regarding accessory dwelling units, such units will be permitted as a matter of right and will not be subject to any requirements, other than obtaining appropriate building permits.

Enactment of this ordinance will bring the Claremont City Code into compliance with state law regarding accessory dwelling units.

The Planning Board, by unanimous vote on March 27, 2017, has recommended approval of the adoption of the zoning amendment language.

Mike McCrory, City Planner, said the new state law goes into effect June 1st. This is about "granny flats." It brings Claremont's zoning ordinance into compliance with state law. ADUs (Accessory Dwelling Units) will be limited to single family homes. Only one ADU will be allowed per lot. Currently, an ADU can only be for someone related to the owner. The new ordinance changes that. The ADU is to be attached to the structure. The size of an ADU can be no more than 40% of the current structure. The new ADU doesn't play into density calculations. Ms. Taylor said you will still have to meet setbacks and have the Planning Board review it.

Mr. Damren said currently an accessory unit can only be occupied by a family member. He asked if that has changed. Mr. McCrory said it will no longer be required to be a family member.

Mr. McCrory said this will not be equivalent to a duplex. It needs to be owner occupied. The ADU can only be rented, not sold. It cannot become a condominium.

Mr. Damren said he will vote no because that changes the character of what people have understood previously regarding accessory units.

Mr. McCrory said if Council doesn't approve this, state law will rule.

Ms. Taylor said this is the state's attempt to mandate local zoning. The City cannot require a familial relationship.

Mr. Temple asked if there is a parking consideration. Mr. McCrory said yes. He was asked if this limits the number of people. Mr. McCrory said it is limited to two bedrooms and the total square feet is limited. Mr. Temple asked if this can become a boarding house. Mr. McCrory said no.

Ms. Taylor said the fire codes will limit the number of residents.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Simonds to adopt Ordinance 554 Zoning – Accessory Dwelling Units on First Reading.

Mr. Koloski read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

Mayor Lovett asked for pamphlets from the Office of Energy and Planning. Mr. McCrory will give them to the City Manager for distribution and he will also include a comparative chart.

Mr. Temple asked about enforcement as we struggle with building and code enforcement now.

Mr. McCrory said he would rather have a process for the Planning Board to review those proposals rather than popping up by right.

Mr. Damren recognizes the greater good is to approve this, but he is strenuously opposed to the change in definition.

Ms. Taylor emphasized that without taking action, the state definition goes into effect. The City will not be able to limit ADUs to relatives. The intent of this is to allow local control where the state has allowed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-1, with Mr. Damren voting no.

Resolution 2017-38 Tire Tracks Funds – Public Hearing

On October 15, 2016 the Claremont Parks & Recreation Department and the Claremont Cycle Depot co-sponsored "Claremont Tire Tracks" (the "Event") to raise funds for refurbishing the bike trails in Moody Park and enhancements to the Waiting Pavilion at the Claremont Amtrak Stop. The Event raised net revenue after expenses of \$1,415.14, which funds the City would like to expend for the intended purpose of the Event and distribute these funds, 50% for the Moody Park bike trail improvements and 50% for Waiting Pavilion enhancements. This authorizes the

City Manager or his designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to withdraw the total amount of \$1,415.14 from the Parks & Recreation Revenue Account and to deposit the sum of \$707.71 into the Parks & Recreation Park Trail Account #14-381-040-2016 and to deposit the sum of \$707.71 to the Amtrak Ad-Hoc Committee Account #14-311-020-0000.

Mary Walter, Finance Director, said the money has already been deposited. We just need the formal motion.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2017-38 Tire Tracks Funds.

Mr. Simonds read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2017-40 Overspend Welfare Budget Up to \$75,000 – Public Hearing

This is to grant permission to overspend the Welfare Department 2017 Budget, as approved, by up to \$75,000.00 to cover client costs, as required by New Hampshire RSA 165:1 et seq.

Such department over-expenditures shall not exceed the total bottom line appropriated for 2017.

Suzanne Carr, Welfare Director, said this is partly due to high rents, lower wages and people having trouble finding places to live. Her original budget request last year was reduced, which is compounding the issue. Her best estimate is that she will need \$75,000 to get through June.

Mr. Koloski said that by state law, this is required. He asked where the money will come from. Ms. Walter said from other departments. It's hard to spend every last dollar. The Police Department has had so many vacancies that there will be a significant amount of money left in that budget at the end of the year.

Ms. Taylor said there is a provision in state law that the City is not allowed to overspend the bottom line.

Ms. Towle asked about workfare. Ms. Carr said we have it, but she is not seeing people who are unemployed; mostly they are underemployed, have disabilities, etc. In NH, it takes an average of 15 months to start receiving Social Security.

Mr. McNutt asked if there is a number of substandard housing units that are being over charged for rent. Ms. Carr said yes, in her opinion.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Pope to adopt Resolution 2017-40 Overspend Welfare Budget Up to \$75,000.

Mr. Damren read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing.

Steve Raymond, Ward1, asked if Social Security recipients have to pay back Welfare.

Ms. Carr said for Social Security and SSI (Supplemental Security Income), we do get reimbursed, but for Social Security Disability, we don't get that back. If someone owns property, a lien is placed on the property. People do workfare if they are able.

Bernie Folta, Ward 3, asked if there are intended/unintended consequences by aggressive code enforcement.

Mr. McNutt said NICE (Neighborhood Improvement through Code Enforcement) is a new endeavor. There will be unintended effects; Ms. Carr is on the NICE team to help mitigate those effects.

Jerome Zullo, Ward 3, asked how people are being monitoring to determine if they need assistance. Ms. Carr said there is an application process. There is no time limit for assistance.

Mayor Lovett closed the public hearing.

Roll call vote: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2017-41 Raise and Appropriate up to \$10,000 for JSL – Public Hearing

The City has closed the Junior Sports League (JSL) Building for public use because it does not meet current building, life safety and ADA requirements for occupancy. The building has a flat membrane roof that is subject to failure unless the temperature of the membrane is properly controlled. The City is currently marketing the building for sale and wants to prevent further deterioration of the structure, which would impact its marketability. No funds for heating the JSL Building were included in the current operating budget and the Council now finds there is a need to authorize funds to provide maintenance levels of heat for the building. This is to raise and appropriate the sum of up to \$10,000.00 to be taken from fund balance (to have no impact on the tax rate) for the purpose of heating the JSL Building at maintenance levels.

Ms. Walter said last year the City didn't appropriate money for the JSL because we were hoping to sell it. We have spent \$9,350 to cover JSL expenses.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2017-41 Raise and Appropriate up to \$10,000 for JSL.

Mr. Simonds read the resolution into the record.

Mr. Koloski asked if the entire building is being heated. Ms. Walter said it is on minimal heat. Mr. Koloski would like to know if the important areas are being heated. Mr. McNutt will check and let Councilors know.

Mr. Simonds asked about snow removal and damage to the roof. Mr. McNutt will check to see if there has been any damage to the membrane.

Ms. Towle said last year Mr. Koloski had asked about selling the building for \$1. Mr. Koloski said he understands that if this goes out for auction, the City can't control its use. He would like to have an update on the condition of the building. He asked if the roof has a 100% rubber membrane. It's been a while since the building was closed and the City still has it and has to continue to maintain it.

Mr. McNutt said the City didn't get any responses to the RFP. It's use potential is problematic. In FY18 the City may have to entertain selling it for a \$1. He will get information regarding the structure.

Mr. Koloski said he is not an advocate for selling it for \$1.

Some suggestions were made for possible uses: regional emergency dispatch, courthouse, or knock it down and make a parking lot to be leased out to the neighbors. Mr. McNutt would like to get an estimate for demolition.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing.

Bernie Folta, Ward 3, said it was too bad rollerskating couldn't be repositioned somewhere else such as the community center.

Steve Raymond, Ward 1, suggested maybe an abutter may want to buy it.

Mayor Lovett closed the public hearing.

Roll call vote: motion carried 5-3 with Ms. Towle, Mr. Temple and Mr. Koloski voting no.

Ratification of Union Contracts

Mr. Temple said he would like to read the contracts before voting on them. There was a consensus of the Council to be able to read the contracts first and to add this to the April 26th meeting.

Finalize 2017 Strategic Plan

CITY OF CLAREMONT

GOALS AND OBJECTIVES FOR 2017

(Council Reviewed 3/22/17)

Fiscal Responsibility:

Item 1- Continue establishing clear operating procedures regarding economic development which will position the City to expand its tax base, recapture lost valuation, raise the median household income, and attract a talented workforce.

- A. Downtown area- Develop options for revitalization (i.e. 79E) that make it not only attractive to business, but also a young work force. Aggressively market these options.
- B. Strategic Marketing Plan identifying Claremont as having centers of excellence/business hubs (i.e. IT, high quality wood based products, precision manufacturing)
- C. Action Plan for neighborhood improvements in the downtown area with associated costs
- D. Compliance of property maintenance codes (w/ particular attention to absentee landlords)
- E. Expand efforts to support existing employers and their growth, using current technology and marketing trends to promote them whenever possible.
- F. Engage a Joint Task Force of stakeholders to revitalize the downtown area.

Council Actions/Directives:

(1)- Identify ordinances that directly relate to economic development, prioritize and refer to Policy

Committee for review/update.

~~*(2)- Establish a Joint Task Force of stakeholders to address the downtown area*~~

~~*(3)- Explore establishing a Finance Committee to review budget and provide recommendations to Council ensuring economic development goals are properly funded*~~

(4)- Establish quarterly meetings with SAU #6 with clear agendas and desired outcomes

(5)- Examine Downtown TIFD

(6)- Increase working knowledge of successful economic development initiatives by attending conferences, lectures, webinars, etc.

*(7)-Collaborate with legislative representatives to create/support bills that provide new economic development incentives **or secure state funding**.*

Item 2 - Continue to collaborate with SAU #6, Granite State College and River Valley Community College as effective economic development and workforce development partners.

- A. Workforce Development – Meet with local employers, identify and document needs, and develop a plan to address those needs with educational and other relevant partners

Council Actions/Directives:

(1)-Establish quarterly meetings with SAU #6 with clear agendas and desired outcomes

(2)-Establish semi-annual roundtable discussions with Granite State and RVCC

Employee Development

Item 2. Focus on preparations for the next round of collective bargaining scheduled to begin in 2016.

- A. Establish collective bargaining timeframe with each unit, and identify negotiating team members

Council Actions/Directives:

~~*(1) Review current negotiated contracts in preparation for collective bargaining*~~

~~*(2) Mayor to assign a council member to each negotiating team to act as a conduit to the Council during negotiations*~~

Item 3. Effective organizational stability and growth includes succession development.

- A. Provide comprehensive overview to incoming city manager to ensure smooth transition.

Council Actions/Directives:

~~*(1) Establish procedure for hiring new manager (i.e. search firm, search committee, etc.)*~~

~~*(2) In the event that a search does not produce a viable candidate, establish plan to hire an interim city manager*~~

~~*(3) Ensure that the 2017 budget includes funds for search*~~

~~*(4)-Review job description and update as necessary*~~

Public Health, Safety and Welfare

Item 2. Continue review of city owned property to assist in putting it to its best use and/or marketing it for sale.

- A. Develop action plan for the timely divesture of property taken via tax deed; recouping lost tax revenue and moving property back onto the tax roll
- B. Provide Council with comprehensive listing of tax-deeded property, City property and abandoned property.
- C. Develop maintenance plan for city properties and, if no use is designated, send out RFPs for use

Council Actions/Directives:

- (1)-Acquire training with regard to the tax deeding process in order to provide better direction*
- (2)-Identify ordinances pertaining to the maintenance/divesture of City-owned property and forward to Policy Committee for review.*

Item 3. Continue to use available resources to tackle needed road, water and sewer infrastructure improvements

- A. Provide Council overview of water and sewer system, to include upgrades completed, current issues/needs, and plan to address those issues according to a priority system with cost structure
- B. Allocate a minimum of \$500,000 for road maintenance in budget proposal
- C. Provide plan to upgrade sidewalks in the downtown area and throughout main arteries
- D. Aggressively pursue grant opportunities to fund infrastructure improvements

Council Actions/Directives:

- (1)-Identify ordinances that relate to above items, prioritize and send to Policy Committee for review/update.*
- ~~*(2)-Review Sewer/Water Rates and consider options for upgrading water/sewer infrastructure*~~
- (3)-Ensure roads and sidewalks are funded as aggressively as possible given current resources*
- (4)-Collaborate with legislative representatives to create/support bills that provide new or increased revenue sources for infrastructure improvements*

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Mr. Koloski to accept the changes as discussed and provided in the Council packet.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

None

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Mr. Koloski asked for an update on a tour of the Sullivan smokestack. He said people are still getting in the building and starting fires.

Mr. Koloski said the JSL is a liability property. There is possible lead contamination and black mold. Also, he would like an update on the Central Street property. Mr. McNutt asked Mr. Koloski to email him the list of requests.

Mr. McNutt said regarding the tour of the community center that we have not received a response from all Councilors. We will schedule the smokestack tour later.

Mr. Simonds said the smokestack is not the safest place to have nine people go inside. Mr. Koloski said the point is that other people are going in.

Mr. Koloski said that on the alleyway toward the Police Department several pavers are missing. He asked who is responsible to replace them. In the back of the old Pleasant Restaurant, there are two or four pallets of pavers. Ms. Towle said that Mr. Koloski has brought this up three times in the last couple years. Mr. McNutt said he will look into it.

Mr. Temple said about a year or so ago, there was a discussion about merging the land between Moody Park and the adjacent City property known as the sand pit area. Part of the agreement was to have the property surveyed. He would like to see the motion and the map that was recorded. Ms. Taylor said that is in process. Mr. Temple said he would like to see where the money was to come from and would like to see the map of the merge.

Ms. Towle said that Mr. Koloski had received several complaints about certain issues. Her concern is that the City is not getting back to those people. She said it is important to her to know that communication is happening.

Mr. Bergeron thinks it is a good idea to look into the cost of demolishing the JSL building. He thinks the City has done its share of giving things to nonprofits.

Mr. McNutt said he would like to look at the cost of demolition. Potential lead contamination could be a concern.

Mr. Koloski said the road in front of Burger King is deteriorating. He asked if there is any plan for that.

Mayor Lovett said she will send follow-up items to Mr. McNutt for the City Manager's Report.

Mayor Lovett asked when Mr. McNutt would like to discuss the strategic plan for the community center. Mr. McNutt said during the budget presentation.

Mayor Lovett said the Finance Committee will be made up of three Councilors including herself. She asked what the process is. Ms. Taylor said it would be the Mayor's appointment. Applications should be sent to deForest Bearse, Resource Coordinator.

Mr. Bergeron asked when Council will discuss the budgets. Mayor Lovett suggested Councilors think about that and to have a plan for the April 26th meeting.

Mr. Temple said regarding the smokestack that there was a fair amount of effort to secure the building years ago. Because of the recent fire, he suggested the Police put it on the Hotsheet for patrolling.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 10:00 p.m., a motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Simonds to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council